

12.3 Other Features

12.3.1 Reports

FreeProxy has, inbuilt, a comprehensive set of logging and reporting tools to monitor the URLs accessed so that the administrator has better control over how resources are used. Reports can be accessed from the options button in the Control Center. Several types of reports are available, and the ones you set up depend solely on your needs and your ability to manage that much data. For instance, you might want to set an Access Log to keep track of how many times URLs on the Forbidden list were accessed. Of course, if you're really nosy on what everyone is up to, you *can* set the Log Message Content to keep a log of information from every single page visited. We guess this might be of use only to extremely secure and security-crazy networks, since performance is bound to get severely affected, especially on large networks.

For a compromise between total message content logs and access logs, you can also set the Summary Stats, which gives the volume totals of IPs and protocol (HTTP, FTP, etc.) or Set Connection Statistics, which gives you details on sites visited etc. per connection session.

12.3.2 The Web Cache

Caches are an integral part of proxy servers since they significantly reduce the load on the Internet server. As the name suggests, a web cache works by keeping a local copy of documents or Web pages accessed frequently in order to improve overall response and reduce traffic.

We make special mention of the web cache here since the cache in FreeProxy is a built-from-scratch application based on the RFC2616 specifications and has pretty decent performance and features.

When you click on the Cache button in the FreeProxy Control Center, you need to first decide on whether you want to enable